

Assessing fetal growth and well-being

In addition to monitoring your own health and well-being throughout your pregnancy, the doctor will also assess how your baby is growing, and will refer you for further tests if she has any concerns about your baby's well-being.

Measuring your baby

In a low-risk pregnancy, your doctor measures your abdomen at prenatal visits to assess the baby's growth. The measurement in centimeters from the top of the uterus, the fundus, to the top of the pubic bone should be the same as the number of weeks of pregnancy with an allowance of up to 2 cm either way. For example, if you are 26 weeks' pregnant, you should measure between 24 and 28 cm. Your fundal height can be measured from 24 weeks until about 36–37 weeks.

If there is a variation of 3 cm or more, your doctor will arrange for an ultrasound to check your [baby's growth](#) and the amount of amniotic fluid. If the scan indicates a problem, the doctor will arrange for scans every two weeks since analyzing growth patterns over time gives a more accurate assessment of whether your baby's growth is normal.

In certain cases, for example if a woman is obese, in twin pregnancies, and where there are large uterine fibroids, the only accurate way to measure growth is by ultrasound.